

Pennsylvania ACA Rating Areas: Verified CMS Reference & Attrition Map

This document contains the verified federal/state CMS County-to-Rating-Area mapping for Pennsylvania (CMS Source: [pa-gra](#)), along with consolidated and modular Mermaid diagrams for repository documentation.

1. Official CMS Geographic Rating Area Mapping Table

Rating Area	Core Regional Designation	Assigned Counties
1	Northwestern PA	Erie, Crawford, Mercer, Venango, Clarion, Forest, Warren, McKean
2	North-Central PA	Elk, Cameron, Potter
3	Northern Tier & Poconos	Tioga, Clinton, Lycoming, Sullivan, Bradford, Susquehanna, Wyoming, Lackawanna, Wayne, Pike, Monroe, Carbon, Luzerne
4	Southwestern PA / Pittsburgh Metro	Lawrence, Beaver, Washington, Greene, Butler, Allegheny, Westmoreland, Armstrong, Indiana, Fayette
5	Central PA / Allegheny Plateau	Jefferson, Clearfield, Cambria, Somerset, Bedford, Blair, Huntingdon
6	Central-East PA / Lehigh Valley	Centre, Mifflin, Union, Snyder, Montour, Northumberland, Columbia, Schuylkill , Lehigh, Northampton
7	South-Central PA / Dutch Country	Adams, York, Lancaster, Berks
8	Southeastern PA / Philadelphia Metro	Chester, Delaware, Montgomery, Bucks, Philadelphia
9	Capital Region / Harrisburg Metro	Fulton, Franklin, Cumberland, Perry, Juniata, Dauphin, Lebanon

2. Combined Single-Page State Poster Diagram

```
graph TD
    subgraph StateOverview["Pennsylvania ACA Individual Market:  
Attrition Intensity by Rating Area"]
        direction TB

        subgraph TierCritical["High Impact Areas (≥50% Top-20  
Attrition Density)"]
            subgraph RA6["Rating Area 6 – Central-East PA"]
                SC["Schuylkill: 24% Rural - Outlier/Carrier  
Exits"]:::critical
                LE["Lehigh: 22% Urban"]:::high
                NA["Northampton: 22% Urban"]:::high
                MI["Mifflin: 20% Rural"]:::moderate
                SN["Snyder: 20% Rural"]:::moderate
                RA6_Other["Centre, Union, Montour, Northumberland,  
Columbia"]:::nodata
            end
            end

            subgraph RA9["Rating Area 9 – Capital Region"]
                FU["Fulton: 22% Rural"]:::high
                FR["Franklin: 21% Rural"]:::high
                JU["Juniata: 20% Rural"]:::moderate
                CU["Cumberland: 19% Urban"]:::moderate
                LB["Lebanon: 19% Rural"]:::moderate
                RA9_Other["Perry, Dauphin"]:::nodata
            end
            end
        end

        subgraph TierSevere["Moderate-High Impact Areas (25%-75%  
Top-20 Attrition Density)"]
            subgraph RA7["Rating Area 7 – South-Central PA"]
                LA["Lancaster: 22% Urban"]:::high
                AD["Adams: 19% Rural"]:::moderate
                YK["York: 19% Rural"]:::moderate
                RA7_Other["Berks"]:::nodata
            end
            end

            subgraph RA5["Rating Area 5 – Central PA / Plateau"]
                CL5["Clearfield: 19% Rural"]:::moderate
                BL5["Blair: 19% Rural"]:::moderate
                RA5_Other["Jefferson, Cambria, Somerset, Bedford,  
Huntingdon"]:::nodata
            end
            end

            subgraph RA3["Rating Area 3 – Northern Tier & Poconos"]
```

```

        TI3[Tioga: 21% Rural]:::high
        MO3[Monroe: 21% Rural]:::high
        CA3[Carbon: 19% Rural]:::moderate
        RA3_Other["Clinton, Lycoming, Sullivan, Bradford,
Susquehanna, Wyoming, Lackawanna, Wayne, Pike, Luzerne"]:::nodata
    end

    subgraph RA4["Rating Area 4 – Southwestern PA / Pittsburgh
Metro"]
        GR4[Greene: 22% Rural]:::high
        BE4[Beaver: 20% Urban]:::moderate
        RA4_Other["Lawrence, Washington, Butler, Allegheny,
Westmoreland, Armstrong, Indiana, Fayette"]:::nodata
    end
end

    subgraph TierBaseline["Low/Unreported Impact Areas (No Top-20
Attrition Reported)"]
        RA1["Rating Area 1 – Northwest PA<br/>(Erie, Crawford,
Mercer, Venango, Clarion, Forest, Warren, McKean)"]:::nodata
        RA2["Rating Area 2 – North-Central PA<br/>(Elk, Cameron,
Potter)"]:::nodata
        RA8["Rating Area 8 – Philadelphia Metro<br/>(Chester,
Delaware, Montgomery, Bucks, Philadelphia)"]:::nodata
    end
end

classDef critical
fill:#ff0000,color:#fff,stroke:#990000,stroke-width:3px
classDef high fill:#ffcccc,stroke:#cc0000
classDef moderate fill:#fff4e6,stroke:#ff6600
classDef nodata fill:#e8e8e8,stroke:#999

```

3. Cross-Rating-Area Attrition & Density Summary Table

Rating Area	Total Counties	Counties in Top-20 Attrition List	% of Area Affected	Worst County (Rate)	Primary Geographic Trait
RA 6	10	5	50%	Schuylkill (24%)	Mixed; severe rural carrier exit outlier
RA 9	7	5	71%	Fulton (22%)	Capital region; heavy rural concentration
RA 7	4	3	75%	Lancaster (22%)	South-central; high proportion hit
RA 5	7	2	29%	Clearfield / Blair (19%)	Central plateau; moderate rural floor
RA 3	13	3	23%	Tioga / Monroe (21%)	Northern tier & Poconos; rural
RA 4	10	2	20%	Greene (22%)	SW PA / Pittsburgh metro fringe
RA 1	8	0	0%	None reported	Northwest border
RA 2	3	0	0%	None reported	Upper rural core
RA 8	5	0	0%	None reported	Philadelphia urban core

Analytical Implementation Notes

1. **Spatial Aggregation:** FIPS codes mapped to Rating Areas 1–9 match official CMS state filings. Avoid using legacy 5-digit ZIP mappings where ZIP codes span county lines.
2. **Data Thresholds:** Counties marked as nodata fell below Pennie's 19% reporting threshold for the top-20 attrition dataset.
3. **Schuylkill County Context:** Schuylkill County is positioned in Rating Area 6. The 24% attrition rate corresponds directly to carrier withdrawals (Ambetter and Partners), leaving UPMC as the remaining option with an average monthly premium increase of \$347 (+186%).